

DOWNTOWN

Sunday
September 13, 2026

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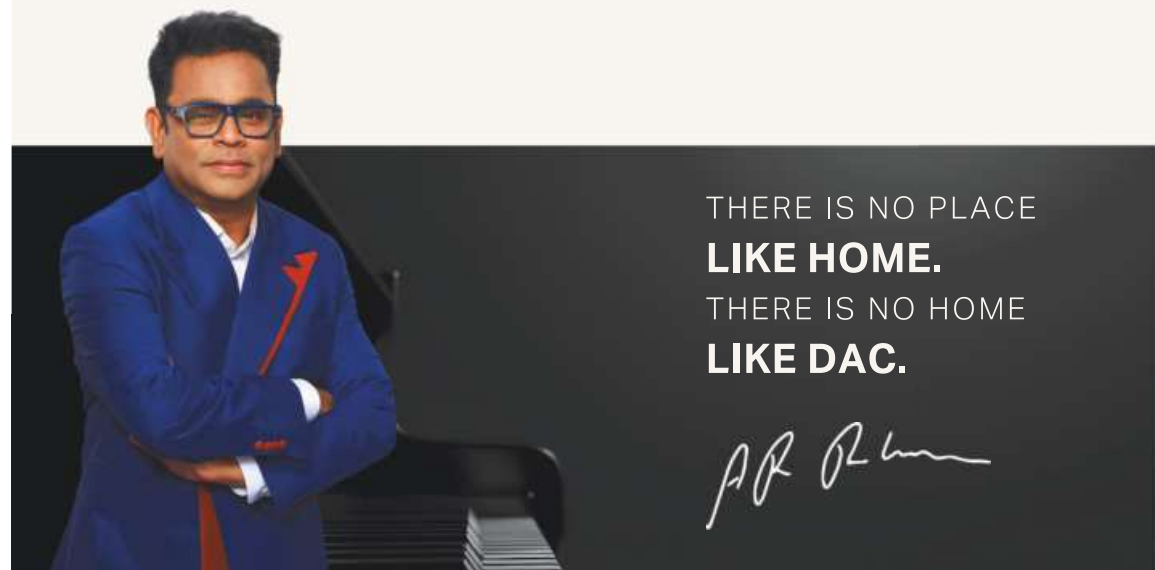
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Getting past the vegetable shops

On Chitrakulam West Street, parents struggle to get their children to school on time



A truck unloads vegetables at the market in Chitrakulam West Street, on September 9. PHOTO SRINATH M

M. SRINATH

The pavement on one side of Chitrakulam West Street boasts a staggering number of vegetables shops.

Mylapore and Mandaveli residents navigate this street to drop their wards at school, as it connects to Sundareswarar Street where Sir Sivasamy Kalalaya is located; Lady Sivasamy Iyer Girls School and PS Senior Secondary School at Venkatesa Agraharam and Vidya Mandir at Kalvivarur Street; and at RK Mutt Road, PS Matriculation and PS Higher Secondary School.

Chitrakulam West Street is already encroached upon by the vegetable vendors and on top of that, of-flooding of vegetables from trucks in the morning peak hours hinders the movement of school goers.

Balaji, a parent of a student from Sir Sivasamy Kalalaya, notes that vegetable trucks arrive only during the school hours and pose a threat to the safety of passersby.

Vasavi, a parent of a student from Vidya Mandir, echoes that sentiment.

One of the parents expressed the view that without the deployment of traffic police personnel to handle the traffic during the morning rush hour, this issue cannot be addressed.

A humour-packed evening dedicated to teachers

Eighteen teachers will be presented with the Best Teacher Award at the monthly programme of Humour Club to be held today in Mylapore

Eighteen teachers will be hogging the limelight at the monthly meeting of Humour Club International - Triplicane chapter. As part of Teachers' Day celebration, the Club will be recreating some "teaching" moments to give audience as well as all the special invitees a memorable evening.

The school bell will ring when the curtains on the stage go up and the 18 Best Teacher Awardees will be shown to the audience. Short clips from Tamil films showcasing student-teacher relationship will be screened.

Of the 18 awardees four are members of the humour club. The list includes retired teachers and

many currently serving in schools or colleges.

Nonagenarian Vatsala Narayanaswamy, an educationist and director of Sivaswami Kalalaya; and V. Susheela, honorary correspondent of Avvai Home and Orphanage for Girls are the senior awardees. Others include: Sarojini Gowrishankaran, R. Vaidyanathan, Visalakshi Jambunathan, S. Kannan, A. Stella Mary, Gowri Ramesh, P. Gurumoorthy, SV Kalyani, Archana Prasad, Yamuna Harshavarshana; Natarajan M; R. Anitha; G. Kalaivani; N. Kavitha; D. Muthulakshmi; and V. Deepa.

Pulavar Ramalingam is the special guest at the programme starting at 4 p.m. at Mylapore Fine Arts Club, Mylapore. Call: 9841532212.

The regulars at Nageswara Rao Park

P. LEENA DHARANI

As Nageswara Rao Park in Mylapore has been undergoing a complete revamp for more than nine months, many regulars have stopped visiting the park. But a group of fitness enthusiasts did not stop visiting this park even when it was in a bad shape.

With a heavy heart we have witnessed the uprooting of so many trees. As a result of trees being felled, many birds and bats lost their homes. For the last few months, it was hard for us to find a comfortable spot to do exercises, but that has not deterred us from visiting the park.

I am part of the 'Park Aerobics' group and we continue to meet at the park for our daily routine. When it rains, we unfurl our umbrellas. Sonia Sanjay guides us with her expertise in aerobics and yoga. We follow a format: 30 to 50 minutes of aerobics, laughter exercises, asanas and last 10



minutes for meditation, affirmations and mind exercises. Earlier, we could be spotted at the other entrance of the park. We would carry brooms to sweep the place.

After exercises, there is a dance session by Zee Tamil fame 'Venu master'. Different songs are played on the speaker and gentle freestyle movements are taught by the master. Then we move to a small area near the gym for a ka-



Members of the Park Aerobics group.

raoke song session. This session is done under the mentorship of Ram Surender, a professional singer. Members sing their favourite songs and enjoy their togetherness.

To avoid boredom and to strengthen bonds, birthday celebrations and monthly outings are organised by this team of eight to 10 people. Every month, a music studio is booked. Every Sunday morning, we join the public speaking forum, mainly for children and young adults, conducted by retired banker T. Narayanaswamy. With the remodelling of the park happening in full swing, the group only hopes for a better, greener and cleaner park for all. We welcome walkers to join us and make the park more vibrant.

P. Leena Dharani is a resident of Paripoorna Vinayagar Koil Street in Mylapore and a member of the group

'Navaneetham teacher' remembered

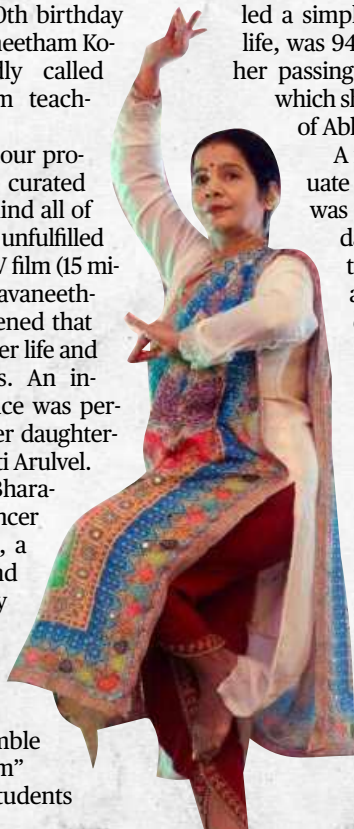
Ten students received scholarships at an event organised to celebrate the centenary year of the headmistress of Chennai Higher Secondary School, Alwarpet



From the event.

On August 23, family and friends got together to celebrate the 100th birthday of Late Navaneetham Kollandai, fondly called 'Navaneetham teacher'.

The two-hour programme was curated keeping in mind all of her likes and unfulfilled wishes. An AV film (15 minutes) on Navaneetham was screened that highlighted her life and achievements. An invocation dance was performed by her daughter-in-law, Bharati Arulvel. Renowned Bharatanatyam dancer Roja Kannan, a family friend and a colony neighbour, paid a special tribute with a dance ensemble "Samarpanam" along with students



from her dance school, Bharatha Natyalaya Academy.

Navaneetham Kollandai, who led a simple yet accomplished life, was 94 years at the time of her passing, about 65 years of which she spent as a resident of Abhiramapuram.

A first generation graduate from her family, she was married to N. Kollandai, former Superintendent of Police, and they have two children - Uma and Arul. She completed her BSc in Zoology backed by her Bachelors in Teachers' training and evolved being a great teacher, liked both by her students and colleagues, said a release. She retired in the year 1985 as the Headmistress of Chennai Higher Secondary School in Alwarpet.

Besides teaching

science, she was deeply interested in Tamil scriptures, Indian and Greek mythology, religion and arts. She put in considerable effort in her teaching methods and used to demonstrate them through art as she was brilliant in drawing and clay modelling, says her son in the note shared with *The Hindu Downtown*. Her real passion and interests were in art, specifically Bharatanatyam, playing the veena, kolam designing, drawing, reading books and gardening.

She was a great mother and an extremely strong-willed lady, widowed early in life, managing both work and home front all alone. She had an illustrious career as a teacher and was a strict disciplinarian.

A highlight of the function was higher secondary school students from Chennai School, Alwarpet, about 10 of them receiving scholarships and merit certificates from the family seniors. Headmistress K. Revathy was also present. A book on Navaneetham Kollandai was released at the function.

Special sweet boxes

Sri Krishna Sweets is bringing special sweets and savouries boxes for Ganesh Chaturthi. Each box includes mysurpa, laddu, sweet kozhukattai, adhirasam, sweet seva, aval mixture, milagu thattai and kara kozhukattai.

With this box, one will receive a Vinayagar clay statue

and *prasadam*. The special boxes will be available on September 13 and 14 at all their outlets. On September 14, hot sweet and kara kozhukattai will be available in various outlets including Adyar, Alwarpet, Egmore, Mylapore and Triplicane from 9 a.m. to 1 p.m.

Festival collection

Thughil, a store for handlooms, is having a festival sale of curated handloom, cotton, natural-dyed saris, dress material, readymades and festival gifts. The highlights of the sale include silk cottons, hand-block prints, tie & dye and Pen-Kalamkari saris, wall-panels, duppattas, hand-crafted bags. The sale is on September 18 and 19 at C.P.Arts Centre, Mini hall(2), Alwarpet. Contact no: 7395972701 Timings 10.30am to 7pm.

School students work on food business ideas



The third edition of Sprouts IDEA Tank saw school students showcase imagination, creativity and teamwork to present their ideas.

This year's theme, "Foodpreneurs: Flavours that Sell," held on September 9, brought together 11 schools, with students turning simple food ideas into interesting business propositions. The afternoon was enriched by the perspectives of restaurateur Manoj Padmanaban (BORN) and professor Pulkit Marwaha (Masters' Union), who engaged with the young entrepreneurs.

After two hours of enthusiastic pitching, Vruksha Montessori, Sprouts Montessori High School and Akshar Arbol emerged as the winners. KC High received the award for Innovation, Sprouts' second team was recognised for Marketing,

and DAV Boys Gopalapuram received the award for the Most Cost-Effective Budget, said a release.

In October, Sprouts is partnering with BML Munjal University for "Heroes of Tomorrow". The initiative will bring together schools from across the city for a multi-layered, SDG-aligned learning experience.

Open House on September 19

Sprouts will conduct its Montessori Open House on September 19, offering parents an opportunity to understand the key areas of learning and development, explore the thoughtfully prepared environment, and see how children learn through choice, movement, practice, exploration and purposeful work.

Sprouts Montessori and High School is at Luz Avenue Road, Mylapore.

READERS WRITE

A 'novel' board at Dr. Ranga Road

Bala Medicals on Dr. Ranga Road has displayed names of a few doctors in Mylapore along with their specialisations. A nice thought by the medical shop

Baskar Seshadri is a resident of Mylapore

SWD covers broken in CIT Colony

RAMDAS NAIK

All along First Main Road in CIT Colony, the stormwater drain covers are in a broken condition and have not been replaced despite repeated complaints.

Besides, desilting has to be undertaken before the monsoon.

Ramdas Naik is secretary of CIT RWA, Mylapore





LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

S ydenhams Road in Periamet is the “wardrobe” for blue collar workers. On this oft-crowded thoroughfare, from the point where the Greater Chennai Corporation’s headquarters (Ripon Building) begins to the point where the Nehru stadium almost ends, around thirty shops, some found in a cluster and others spaced apart, provide passersby with a peek into this wardrobe.

There is something for almost every front-line worker under the sun. Uniform for security personnel; safety jackets for those working amidst traffic; safety helmets for construction workers; gear tailored for house keeping staff and conservancy workers; shoes, boots, caps and belts associated with the police force; general caps; and laboratory coats. Do not let that “and” hoodwink the reader into thinking this list is exhaustive. It hardly is. Bulk orders placed by corporates government agencies, education institutions and construction companies among others as well as individual purchases sustain this business. And for novelty, orders sometimes fly in from cricket leagues and franchises.

This visual side to Sydenhams Road is familiar for old timers; and it remains its dominant feature. For the superficial eye, little has changed. Can that be said about the eye that has been taking in this “scenery”, day in day out, for years, and even decades? Has anything in the market shifted significantly? As it was established in 1945, United Uniform is probably at an advantage while taking that question. It operates from a shop built into the historic Periamet mosque, established in 1838 by hides and skins traders. After Independence, the mosque would go

‘Safety gear is now the major grosser’

Sydenhams Road, dubbed “the Blue Collar Uniform Hub of Chennai”, supports a section of the unorganised sector that only continues to thrive and grow bigger due to a variety of intrinsic factors



through two reconstruction exercises, and that would give birth to these shops, partly defining the lower reaches of the mosque on one side. Kahifullah Khan, the third generation owner of United Uniform, observes this shop was constructed in 1956. At that time, United Uniform was functioning from what was called ‘Red Building’ in Moore Market with the foun-

der and Kahifullah’s grandfather, Hafizullah Khan at the helm. Kahifullah recalls that the enterprise shifted to its current location in the early 1980s following the much-discussed Moore Market fire, an event that led to the scattering of Moore Market traders dealing in various goods to the nooks and crannies of Madras.

On the question of changes, Ka-

Sydenhams Road and an old unorganised business that is still going strong.



hifullah draws attention to the facade of his shop and those of others in the mosque complex. These shops are noticeably below road level, even coming across as basement shops. With a barely concealed chuckle, he remarks that these shops were once above road level; successive road-laying exercises have got them where they are. In every other aspect, according to him, these small enterprises constituting a segment of the unauthorised sector have been on an upward trajectory.

“There are now more shops in this line of business than ever before,” states Kahifullah, adding the changes have had to do with the major buyers’ mindset, and thankfully, meeting those new expectations is hardly a tough ask.

On the dominant category sold by these shops through the decades, Kahifullah points out that in the 1980s, the focus was largely on police-related products and then a shift happened, greater attention now being accorded to medical items, the coats, then NCC and Scouts uniform and accessories. From the 2010s, safety gear is the major grosser: safety shoes, jackets and helmets easily constitute the highest selling category, he states. Yet another noticeable shift has to do with the choice of material for the making of shoes. Around 15 to 17 years ago, the scales tipped in favour of rexine over leather. And Kahifullah believes this change has been driven primarily by “large-scale manufacturing of rexine in Gujarat and Haryana. Some people even import rexine from Korea and China.”

If one parsed through the resilience of these shops, one factor emerges strongly, a bond that goes beyond a common trade. Kahifullah puts a ballpark number on the shops in this line of business on Sydenhams road, thirty-five, and adds that out of that, around 90 percent of them are run by those

that are part of his extended family. He admits there is competitive pricing, but there is also cooperation. In this climate, sourcing items not in one’s stock from others is possible.

One senses a strong sense of connection and continuity best epitomised by Kahifullah himself. He is essentially a techie, having had a long stint in the IT industry, and he peeled himself from it to keep a family legacy going. He joined this business four years ago following his father Shafifullah’s death in 2022.

The narrative about connections and continuity gains greater ground as more conversations are initiated with these tradespeople. At Khaleel Cap Mart, a misnomer as they sell uniform and accessories in addition to caps, Quraishi, 45, who first came to the shop at age 12, during his school days, remarks that the

name ‘Cap Mart’ is a reminder of those early years. The shop originally specialised in caps, from turbans and Muslim prayer caps or Kufis, to Kashmiri caps. As customer requirements changed. So did the shop’s inventory. One of the shop’s most distinctive products is not necessarily the most conspicuous. Its cotton mosquito nets are made in the traditional way and remain popular among police personnel at various police residential quarters. Depending on the bed type, they cost between ₹500 and ₹1,500. Started by Khaleel Ur Rahman, the shop is now run by Quraishi and his brother Nayeem. Quraishi echoes Kahifullah’s sentiment that this business is on an even keel.

Speaking for the tradespeople in his line of business on Sydenhams Road, Quraishi observes digital buying has left no dent in their business. “Individuals might buy a cap online; for bulk orders, they come to us.”

Old Markets, New Trends

This column features markets that have continued to retain their hold on people’s mind space despite the shifting sands of fads. Through entities that have been around for a long time, it seeks to find out what makes these markets tick

G. SOORIYAMOORTHY
AT WORK

The nuts and bolts of creativity

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

At first glance, it resembles a pile of wires. On closer look, the contours of a face become evident. That is the idea behind G. Sooriyamoorthy's "The Imaginative Metal Wire Portrait of an Artist", one of two sculptures he is preparing for Auras Elemental, an art show where he will stage his experiments with unconventional materials and painstaking techniques spanning 26 years. His second work, "Within the Armour", engaged with a different material and manages a distinct effect: nuts and bolts assembled into the form of a warrior.

The works might differ in appearance, but both reflect Sooriyamoorthy's preference for materials that demand time, precision and physical effort.

"People ask me why I am using

Sculptor G. Sooriyamoorthy promotes the idea of "art made difficult"; and there is a method to this madness. His works will be on display at Lalit Kala Akademi from October 10 to 15

metal wire when it is so time-consuming," he says. His welding shop is in Tambaram, requiring him to travel back and forth from his home in Ayanavaram as he works on the sculptures. "People ask why I put in so much effort when there are easier ways of creating art. For me, the effort is part of the process."

To reach its final form, the wire

portrait consumed three months. The idea came from drawing: Sooriyamoorthy imagined a face made up of multiple lines, with each wire functioning like a line on paper. Instead of lying flat, however, the lines intersect and move through space, gradually forming the figure.

The process involved little machinery. Using cutting pliers, he cut, stretched and tightened the wires before weaving them together. Continuous work for even 30 minutes to an hour could leave his hands hurting. The ponytail was particularly demanding, with individual wires cut to different lengths and shaped by hand. "No large machines were used," he says. A small skull-like structure sits at the centre of the composition, helping hold the interwoven wires together. The construction, which resembles basket-making, gives the sculpture stability despite the thin material. The metal was also treated to achieve an antique finish.

His second sculpture began with a different challenge. Sooriyamoorthy had been looking for an opportunity to experiment with nuts and bolts when he conceived the idea of a warrior. But before he could begin welding, he had to work out the figure itself. He first made a clay model, shaping and carving the anatomy while leaving spaces for the nuts and bolts to fit. The model was then used to make a plaster of Paris mold.

The choice of plaster was practical. Welding generates considerable heat, and Sooriyamoorthy says plaster of Paris absorbs the heat and helps keep the metal cool. Fibre, another material that is generally used for larger sculptures, could pose a fire risk under welding conditions. The nuts and bolts were welded from inside the sculpture. For the warrior's hair, he used 8 mm metal rods, bending and shaping them before welding them into place. The clay model was started around four months ago, while the welding took four days.

"I was able to finish it in a short

An eclectic mix of artists

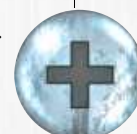
Auras Elemental, an art exhibition featuring artists at different stages of their creative journeys, will be held from 10 to 15 October 2026 at Lalit Kala Akademi, Thousand Lights. The exhibition, which will be inaugurated on October 9, at 5.30 p.m., brings together emerging artists, first-time exhibitors, passionate learners and experienced professionals, creating a space for diverse artistic practices and perspectives.

The title Auras Elemental reflects the exhibition's focus on the energy and presence surrounding artworks and the raw, instinctive nature of creativity. "Auras" refers to the subtle energies associated with each work, while "Elemental" represents creativity in its pure and unrefined form. The exhibition explores how artistic expression takes shape through instinct, intuition and creative impulse.

Bringing together painters, sculptors, visual artists, designers, art educators, installation artists, digital artists and practitioners from various disciplines, the exhibition presents a range of mediums, approaches and artistic journeys.

span of time because I made sure the clay model was perfect in shape. This allowed me to easily weld the nuts and bolts according to my requirements," he says.

The contrast between the two sculptures also points to Sooriyamoorthy's larger approach to materials. Stone remains his favourite, largely because of the difficulty involved in working with it. Fibre is comparatively easier, he says, while metal and stone require greater time and effort. That difficulty, rather than convenience, appears to be what keeps him experimenting. As he gets the two sculptures ready for Auras Elemental, the material is as much a part of the work as the form it eventually takes.



Social media opening doors to child marriages?

On September 4, 2026, the United Nations General Assembly declared November 27 as the International Day for the Elimination of Child, Early and Forced Marriage. Child rights activists in Chennai weigh in on what it takes, particularly in the online space, to counter the evil of child marriage

LIFY THOMAS

Last year, the District Child Welfare Committee in Chennai dealt with a case where a 15-year-old girl from Nepal had married a 28-year-old man working in Chennai, the two having met on Instagram. With the help of friends, they got married in Chennai.

A month into the marriage, the girl was traced after she made a call to her sister in Nepal. The girl's family lodged a complaint with the police following which India Child Protection, a civil society organisation working in the area of child protection, intervened to rescue the girl.

Social media and online dating are increasingly exposing vulnerable girls to greater risk of child marriage.

"With advancement in digital communication, the *modus operandi* in child marriage is changing, making more children vulnerable," says Bhuwan Ribhu, a child rights activist and founder of Just Rights for Children.

Bhuwan Ribhu says trafficking is a borderless crime, and it requires a borderless response. Online methods of enticement or grooming for marriage, sexual abuse and trafficking have become possible irrespective of distance and geography.

In a study taken by NGO Save the Children, they observed that girls in India faced greater online risk of child marriage and trafficking during the pandemic. The agency continues to work with children and teachers to raise awareness about staying safe online.

According to the National Family Health Survey (2019-21), the national average in India for child marriage is 23%. The prevalence rate in India for child marriage has fallen by 10 per cent. The Bal Vivah Mukht Bharat campaign launched by the Central Government in November 2024 promises to make India child marriage-free by 2030 and is seeing various state governments running different initiatives.

A dedicated CMPO needed

Natharsha Malim H, state coordinator - Tamil Nadu, India Child Protection, says while Tamil Nadu has been making steady progress in reporting and stopping child marriages, gaps continue to exist.

Tamil Nadu, he says, does not have Child Marriage Prohibition Officers (CMPOs) that are appointed to prevent marriages, gather evidence, raise awareness and report data. The District Social Welfare Officer (DSWO) is notified as the Child Marriage Prohibition Officer of the concerned district.

ILLUSTRATION: SREEJITH R KUMAR

"This is an additional role that the DSWO takes up. We have been asking for a dedicated person to be appointed as many other states have done based on a Supreme Court recommendation," says Malim.

For example, in Karnataka, the Department of Women and Child Welfare has included pre-university (PU) college principals as child marriage prohibition officers, whose responsibility is to prevent any girl child



studying in their college from marrying before 18 years.

Dedicated officials tasked with curbing this practice is particularly required in places such as Salem, Dindigul, Namakal and Cuddalore which has reported maximum cases of child marriages, says Malim. Grama panchayats have to be empowered in these districts to curb child marriage

A rule book for intervention

Malim notes that State Governments have to draw up a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for elimination of child marriages.

"The Supreme Court came out with a landmark judgement on child marriages in October 2024, but Tamil Nadu is yet to come out with an SOP," he says.

Panchayats that make an earnest effort to stop child marriage should be rewarded; and the bravery of young girls that resist coercion by family into child marriage should also be acknowledged.

Bhuwan Ribhu cites the example of a study done by India Child Protection in 2025, wherein cases in Assam dropped by 84 percent following a continuous crackdown by law-enforcement authorities.

Although Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006 has been in existence for decades, enforcement leaves a lot to be desired.

"With amendments to the law and judgments by the Supreme Court, we have been able to see much impact on the ground, along with greater awareness," says Ribhu, adding, "awareness needs to be supplemented with the enforcement of policies, accountability of institutions, and the use of technology for monitoring."

How to report a child marriage

File a complaint with

Child Marriage Prohibition Officer

District Magistrate
Nearest police station

District Child Protection Unit

ASHA Unit of District Legal Services Authority

Bal Vivah Mukht Bharat portal <https://stopchildmarriage.wcd.gov.in>

Source: Ministry of Women and Child Development

Residents association in Chennai hails UN declaration



On September 4, 2026, when the United Nations General Assembly declared November 27 as the International Day for the Elimination of Child, Early and Forced Marriage, a residents group in Anna Nagar celebrated the announcement.

A small number of residents, close to 150, of Kambar Colony in Anna Nagar gathered at the park in the neighbourhood to watch the live proceedings of the United Nations General Assembly on the designation of November 27 as the International Day for the Elimination of Child, Early and Forced Marriage.

The programme was organised by the ICWO Tamil Nadu and Kambar Colony Welfare Association. The designation is a significant global commitment to strengthening awareness, prevention and action against child, early and forced marriage. This is a victory for children and civil society organisation that have been fighting to end child marriage.

Awareness banners and charts were displayed, and the gathering concluded with an oath-taking ceremony to strengthen the community's commitment to end child marriage.

ICWO is a partner agency with Just Rights with Children in Chennai, working with educational institutions and communities on rights concerning children.

A.J. Hariharan, founder secretary, ICWO, says reporting is the key to preventing child marriage. He notes: "we work closely with schools and colleges to help eradicate child marriage. All what we ask them is report any cases of child marriage to the helpline number or a teacher."

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Meet the 'Face of Chennai 2026'

The grand finale of IRIS Face of Tamil Nadu 2026 and IRIS Face of Chennai 2026 was held in the city recently at Radisson Blu GRT.

Of the 100 contestants that were auditioned, more than 30 were shortlisted for the semifinals. The finalists competed in ethnic wear and formal evening wear rounds, showcasing their style, confidence and stage presence.

The ethnic wear collection by Tata Taneira Sarees was draped by DreamZone - School of Creative Studies.

Special Guests Priyadharshini and Gaayathri also attended the event. The



winners were crowned by C. K. Kumaravel, founder of Naturals.

NATURAL MRS FACE OF CHENNAI 2026

Winner: Swathi, advertising professional

Runner-Up: Greeshma, fashion and brand designer

2nd Runner-Up: Geetha Lakshmi, HR consultant

NATURALS MRS FACE OF TAMIL NADU 2026

Winner: Jayanthi, educationist

Runner-Up: Reshmi, IT professional

This is the 15th edition of IRIS Face of Chennai and the third edition of IRIS Face of Tamil Nadu, with auditions held in Madurai, Trichy, Coimbatore and Chennai, said a release.

The event was conceptualised and presented by Latha A. Krishna and her team at Iris Events.

Annual Day fete at school in Royapettah

Shree Venkateshwarar Matriculation Higher Secondary School in Royapettah celebrated its Annual Day on August 29 with a cultural fervour.

Students presented vibrant cultural programmes, including a drama on Julius Caesar, Tamil skit on uses and abuses of social media and dance by senior students.

Senior Principal and Correspondent Vedha Srinivasan, who presided over the function, addressed the students and parents about the need for discipline and modesty.

Principal Vanathi presented the



annual report and highlighted that 100% results were achieved in both X and XII classes. Achievements in sports and inter-school competitions were also read out.

Excellence of teachers was also rewarded.

The function concluded with the vote of thanks by the English teacher Prathibha

Hope for persons with knee osteoarthritis

Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals has introduced "knee-preservation-first approach" to treat advanced osteoarthritis.

Dr. Deepak Kumar K S, an Orthopaedic Surgeon, Knee Replacement and Mako Stryker expert, carefully evaluates every patient and explores appropriate treatment options to preserve the natural knee before considering replacement surgery, said a press release.

Dr. Deepak has collaborated with Dr. Sathish Kumar Thangamani, a senior assistant professor at Stanley Medical College and consultant at Dr. Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals, to administer allogeneic bone marrow-derived mesenchymal stem cell therapy for select patients with knee osteoarthritis.

New outlet at Chennai Central

Chennai Division of the Southern Railway has inaugurated a catering outlet at Puratchi Thalaivar Dr. M.G.R. Chennai Central Railway Station recently. According to a press release, the food chain brand Al-Baik has been set up under a category called "Premium Brand Catering Outlet."

The outlet offers non-vegetarian and vegetarian food items. It is located at the newly developed concourse area.

The outlet was inaugurated by I. Senthil Kumar, Additional Divisional Railway Manager-II, Chennai Division in the presence of the D. Mohana Priya, Senior Divisional Commercial Manager and other officials of Chennai Division, adds the release.

Velammal Nexus honours teachers with awards

Velammal Nexus felicitated its teachers with service awards and academic excellence awards for their outstanding contributions. To mark their commitment and achievements, the school presented prizes worth ₹70 lakh.

Correspondent M. V. M. Velmohan handed over the cheque to the senior in-charges representing all Velammal Nexus schools on behalf of the awardees.

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Rotary Olympiad gets bigger

Over 3,000 students from 75 schools took part in Rotary Interact Sports Extravaganza (RISE 2026), popularly called as the Rotary Olympiad, held at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium recently.

Organised by Rotary International District 3234, RISE is designed as a platform for school children to showcase their athletic talents. The event aims to promote grassroots sports development and empower young athletes with the confidence needed to compete at both national and international levels, said a release.

The event was inaugurated by the Speaker of the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly, J. C. D. Prabhakar, alongside Rotary District Governor, RI District 3234 Rtn. D. Suresh Jain. The valedictory function featured R. Jones Ferling Raja, IRS, Assistant Commissioner of Customs, who presented medals and certificates to the winning participants.

Suresh Jain emphasised the importance of early intervention in youth athletics, stating that RISE 2026 was designed to identify promising athletes and help them aim higher.

Wildlife photography contest

The Rotary Club of Chennai Crown, in partnership with Madras Photobloggers, is organising 'Yaavarum 2026', a contest for the speech and hearing impaired.

The contest aims to promote wildlife protection through nature conservation and encourage participants to explore, observe, and capture the beauty and importance of the natural world through their own lens. Entries will be accepted till September 30. Each participant may submit up to three photographs, taken with either a mobile phone or a camera.

For registration, log on to <https://forms.gle/btUHUV-DyD26UgZpi8>, a press release said.

SALE IS ON 18th & 19th SEPTEMBER

Thughil, a store for handlooms is having a Festival sale of curated handloom, cotton, natural-dyed saris, dress-material, ready-mades and festival gifts.

The high-lights of the sale include silk-cottons, hand-block prints, Tie & dye and Pen-Kalamkari saris, wall-panels, duppattas, hand-crafted bags

The sale is on 18th & 19th at C.P.Arts Centre, Mini hall (2), Alwarpet. Contact no: 7395972701 Timings 10.30am to 7.00pm.

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